

(b) Types of data

Students should be taught to:

recognise that data can be obtained from primary or secondary sources;

recognise the difference between quantitative and qualitative variables;

recognise the difference between discrete and continuous data;

recognise, understand and use scales of measurement – categorical, rank;

categorise data through the use of well defined, precise definitions, intervals or class boundaries;

understand the meaning of bivariate data which may be discrete, continuous, grouped or ungrouped;

understand, use and define situations for grouped and ungrouped data.

Primary sources could include raw data, surveys, questionnaires which may have more than two categories, investigations and experiments, etc whilst secondary sources could include databases, published statistics, newspapers, internet pages, etc.

Number of pets is quantitative, favourite name is qualitative.

Number of people is discrete, whilst height is continuous.

The registration letter, say P, on a car represents a period of time from 1 August 1996 to 31 July 1997.

The use of class boundaries such as $0 < a \leq 5$ and terms such as class width and class interval will be expected.

Plotting and interpreting points in a 2D framework is expected.

The construction and use of two-way tables, obtained from surveys and questionnaires.